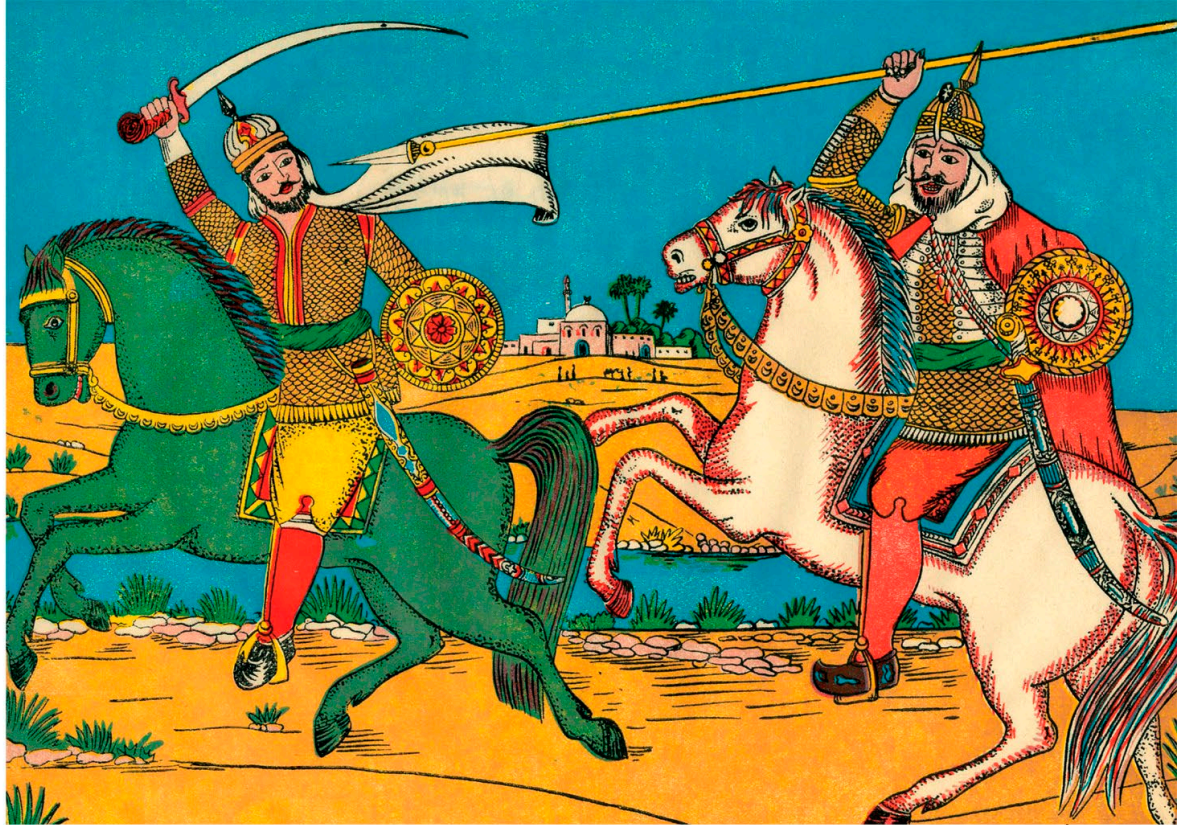


642 CE

SASANIAN PERSIA CONQUERED

Having swept through Byzantine-controlled Palestine and Syria, Muslim Arab armies invaded the Sasanian Persian empire. They won a series of victories against the Persians at al-Qadisiyyah and elsewhere, before destroying the last major Persian army at Nihavand in 642 CE. With most of his generals dead, the Persian ruler escaped, leaving his empire in the hands of the Islamic caliphate.



△ The Battle of Al-Qadisiyyah, from a Persian manuscript

600 CE

613 CE **The Prophet Muhammad** begins preaching in Mecca

622 CE **The Hijra, or Hegira, the journey of Muhammad** and his followers from Mecca to Medina, begins the Islamic era

618 CE

FOUNDATION OF THE TANG

The failed military campaigns and massive projects undertaken by Yang, the Chinese Sui emperor, caused widespread revolt. To stem the chaos, army general Li Yuan took control, deposed the emperor, and declared his own Tang dynasty. Within six years Li Yuan, now emperor Gaozu, had defeated the rebels and united China under Tang rule, a period that lasted nearly 300 years.



◁ Emperor Gaozu of Tang

“With history as a mirror, one can understand the rise and fall of a nation.”

TAIZONG, SECOND TANG EMPEROR, POSTHUMOUSLY PUBLISHED, c. 640 CE